

MATTHEW KATZ

Dallas-Fort Worth, TX · matthew.katz05@gmail.com · github.com/MattTheKatz · linkedin.com/in/matthew-katz-a00414351 · gethitchpilot.com

SUMMARY

UT Dallas Computer Science senior (B.S. expected May 2027) and founder of Toolwright LLC, where I built and launched HitchPilot, a production booking platform with live Stripe payments and automated tests on every change, now in pilot with a trailer-rental yard. Seeking a full-time software engineering role starting Summer 2027.

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Dallas, Erik Jonsson School of Engineering and Computer Science

Richardson, TX

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | *Academic Excellence Scholarship recipient*

Expected May 2027

Relevant Coursework: Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Computer Vision, Advanced Algorithms, Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Database Systems, Software Engineering, Systems Programming in UNIX

EXPERIENCE

Toolwright LLC | Founder and Software Engineer

Aug 2026 – Present

HitchPilot (gethitchpilot.com): online booking and operations platform for small trailer-rental yards. Renters book, e-sign, and pay from a phone; owners get a dashboard, calendar, and automated messaging. In pilot with a Louisiana trailer-rental yard.

- Built the platform end to end in TypeScript with Next.js, React, Prisma, and PostgreSQL (Neon) on Vercel; took it from first commit to a live production site with real card payments in under three weeks (Aug 31 to Sep 17, 2026).
- Integrated Stripe Connect for checkout, deposit holds, refunds, and date changes; webhook reconciliation, idempotency keys, and claim-first locking guarantee that retries and concurrent clicks never double-charge (verified in a live-money rehearsal).
- Built scheduled messaging workflows (confirmations, pickup instructions, return reminders, late notices) over SMS with an email fallback, with deduplication so a renter never receives the same message twice and caps on late notices.
- Implemented e-signed rental agreements: terms are snapshotted and hashed at signing, the signed PDF is emailed to the renter, and license and condition photos are stored in a private object store.
- Built an LLM-powered SMS assistant (Anthropic API over Twilio) for renter questions, with guardrails against prompt injection and look-alike-character tricks, reply validation, rate limits, and carrier-compliant opt-out handling.
- Automated a safety net that runs on every change: Vitest unit tests for pricing and fee math, integration tests against a real database, browser end-to-end tests that book a trailer and work the owner dashboard, and a post-deploy check of public pages.
- Hardened the app to a production standard: strict Content Security Policy, secure session cookies, server-side input validation, invite-only staff accounts, rate limiting, audit logging, and automated code, secret, and dependency scanning.

Cheddar's Scratch Kitchen (Darden Restaurants) | Dishwasher

Summer 2025

- Kept the cook line and service stations supplied through peak dinner service at a high-volume restaurant; handled end-of-night breakdown and sanitation on closing shifts.

PROJECTS

AsteroidsPlus 2 | *Team game project, UT Dallas*

Fall 2023

Processing (Java), Git and GitHub. Five-person team using feature branches and pull requests; implemented the ship-selection screen and integrated sprite and audio assets.

Roblox Development | *Luau, Roblox Studio*

2021 – 2025

Several years of Luau scripting in Roblox Studio, building gameplay systems and tools for prototype projects; adopted the Rojo and Wally toolchain for source-controlled, package-based development.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Java, SQL, C, C++, Lua/Luau, Bash

Frameworks and Libraries: React, Next.js, Node.js, Prisma, Tailwind CSS, Vitest, NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn

Cloud and Tools: PostgreSQL (Neon), Vercel serverless, REST APIs and webhooks, Stripe, Twilio, Git and GitHub, CI/CD, Linux/UNIX

AI: LLM integration (Anthropic API), prompt-injection defenses

LEADERSHIP AND ACTIVITIES

UT Dallas Wind Ensemble | Trumpet

Fall 2023 – Present

Drum Corps International (World Class) | Trumpet, Crossmen (2023) and Colts (2024); two full summer national tours 2023 – 2024